ALCHEMY AOE ALLIANCE

TYPE: STANDARD (STND)		PROJECT: N/A
STND--004		**REVISION: R3**

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1 - Referenced Documents

This “Standard” does not depend on any components.

2 - Definitions

The following definitions apply:

- *Alchemy AOE Licensing* – Per the following link: https://github.com/Alchemy-AOE-Community/CHEM-Random-Map-Scripts/blob/_About_/LICENSE.md

3 - Background

The original iteration of this document was drafted by “old ViridArx” guild members and referred to as “SPC-5”. Released October 26th, 2023, it was used to develop maps for Alchemy League Season 1, and initial iterations of “Space Maps”. In June 2024, “SPC-5” was partitioned into two documents: one containing general requirements suitable for development of random maps of any community (“STND-002”), and this specification, written only for the Alchemy AOE Community.

4 - Overview

This document defines programmatic requirements for supplier-designed random maps used in an Alchemy AOE Alliance competition. The nature of these requirements is such that they require no knowledge of Age of Empires II in order to satisfy.

5 - Location

Submission of a map for use in an Alchemy AOE event is an agreement that it will be used to expand our collection of random maps, but it must be configured in a way that the auto-download script for players can detect.

5.A - Maintenance

The file shall be maintained, at least until conclusion of the parent competition, within a logical branch of the Alchemy AOE random map script repository: https://github.com/Alchemy-AOE-Community/CHEM-Random-Map-Scripts.

5.B - Folder & Naming

The random map shall be contained in a sub-folder of **identical** name, prefixed for the competition with numerical discriminator (if both are provided) and separated by underscores. For example the folder for the fourth map in a “Tales of King Arthur” (ToKA) themed competition could be: “ToKA_04_Camelot”, and the map script in that case would be “ToKA_04_Camelot.rms”.

If map name would change as a result of versioning, then the sub-folder containing that .rms file must be renamed in accordance with version as well.

The presence of any additional files or folders in this sub-folder is immaterial.

5.C - Thumbnail

If the map is developed in conjunction with a component specification, then its folder described in §5.B shall posses a sub-folder named “Gallery”, containing an image file intended for website thumbnail:

- Named Thumbnail.png (portable network graphics format)
- Portrays the map “overview”
- 500x500 pixel dimensions

Following the example in §5.B, corresponding thumbnail located as follows: General_Repository_Workshop_Link/ToKA_04_Camelot/Gallery/Thumbnail.png

The presence of any additional files or folders in the Gallery sub-folder is immaterial.

6 - Licensing

A random map script is a work of intellectual property, entitled to all rights and privileges generally associated with the labor of ideas.

6.A - Identification Format

The random map script shall posses a header containing the following information, in the following order:

- Map Name
- Name of Originator
- Date of Origination
- Names of Collaborators with how they contributed – E. G. JohnDoe – <TERRAIN_GENERATION>, 50% … or JohnDoe – Land Generation For Southern Islands, etc. If there were no collaborators then this section may be skipped. Block code compiled by a computer program is credited to whoever selected its inputs – and not the developer of the tool.
- Notice of consent to use the random map script –at a minimum— in the Alchemy AOE Competition to which it is submitted, also meaning that participants can make money streaming their point-of-view playing on the custom map.
- Link to any applicable component specification, giving high-level overview of map features.

All persons listed as collaborators shall agree with all header contents.

6.B - Exclusivity

Submission of a random map script for use in an Alchemy AOE competition, is a pledge not to license it in any other application, until at least one of the following are true:

- The map is not used in the Alchemy AOE competition as originally planned.
- The parent Alchemy AOE competition has ended.
- A period of six months has passed from that competition’s start date (when games may begin).

In this way, random maps developed under the auspices of the Alchemy AOE Community provide it with the advantage of being the “first” community to offer a competitive environment for those maps. This includes upload of the map to forums or services that would nullify Alchemy AOE map licensing, such as the official AOE2DE mod workshop.

7 - New Work

Maps proposed for use in an Alchemy AOE Competition shall satisfy both of the following conditions prior to the start of the event:

- Pursuant to §6.B, the map –or any similar variant— is not, and has never been, uploaded to a forum or service that nullifies Alchemy AOE licensing.
- The map does not have a Liquipedia article: https://liquipedia.net/ageofempires/Category:Age_of_Empires_II_Maps

8 - Conclusion

This standard covers programmatic requirements for Alchemy AOE random maps, including navigation, licensing, and novelty requirements.

Signatures:

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Prepared — *Date (YYYY-MM-DD)*

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Checked — *Date (YYYY-MM-DD)*

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Revision History:

Revision	Description	Change Document	Date (YYYY-MM-DD)
X1	Advanced release for community review/feedback.	N/A	2024-06-09
OI	Clarified date of origination as required information, split off from names of collaborators.	N/A	2024-06-12
R1	Updated to new spec formation, in addition to other changes: § 5, REMOVED: “The file shall be maintained, at least until conclusion of the parent competition, within a logical sub-folder of the Alchemy AOE random map script repository …” § 5, revised FROM: “Submission of a map for use in an Alchemy AOE event is an agreement that it will be used to expand our collection of random maps.” TO: “Submission of a map for use in an Alchemy AOE event is an agreement that it will be used to expand our collection of random maps, but it must be configured in a way that the auto-download script for players can detect.” § 5.A, added “Maintenance” section. § 5.B, added “Folder & Naming” section.	N/A	2025-03-14
R2	§5.B, revised (all instances) FROM: “ToKA_04_CAMELOT” TO: “ToKA_04_Camelot”, reflecting that convention is **not** all-capitalization. §5.C, added: “Thumbnail” section.	N/A	2026-01-20
R3	§6.B, third bullet revised FROM: “A period of three months has passed from that competition’s start date (when games may begin)”, TO: “A period of six months has passed from that competition’s start date (when games may begin)”.	N/A	2026-10-23